is refuted by the findings of Professor Anatol Lieven: 'The military (Pakistani) is tied to Pakistan, not the universal Muslim Ummah of the radical Islamists' dreams.'

Conversely, an independent observer who taught strategy to Pakistan's civil servants at Staff College, Lahore, was of the opinion that this threat was not an outright implausibility anymore. He argued that an attack on the General Headquarters of Pakistan Army in Rawalpindi and a successful attack on the well-fortified Mehran naval base had shattered the myth of impregnability into the armed forces' set-ups. Nevertheless, he admitted that safety measures of the nuclear arsenal and programme were many notches up and could not be compared with that of the GHQ and naval base. The probability is quite low. But Rolf Mowatt-Larssen, a former investigator for CIA and the US Department of Energy, explained that the low probability had to be weighed against the awfulness of the consequences. He was of the view that 'the odds are stacked against' terrorists acquiring a nuclear bomb. However, he added that in today's unpredictable world, 'a probability-based approach to managing risk' made less sense than one 'focused on mitigating threats in descending order of their possible consequences'.

The probability factor is not Pakistan-specific. Every nuclear state falls in this category. Nevertheless, three aspects must be taken into consideration to ascertain the seriousness of the threat probability of Pakistani nukes falling to the hands of the terrorists: (1) to identify who are desirous of laying their hands on Pakistani nukes; (2) to assess their strength and penetration that may enable them to accomplish this mission, by which all main terrorist organisations should be subjected to scrutiny and (3) to take stock of the security measures taken by Pakistan to protect its nukes.

Before discussing these aspects, it is important to understand that the nuclear programme has a special place in the heart of Pakistanis:

> There remains a mythical belief in the invincibility of nuclear weapons as the ultimate guarantor of national survivability. Under the leadership of Zulfikar Ali Bhutto (1971–77) the country had resolved 'never again' to suffer the humiliation as it did in the 1971 war with India.[9]

It became a symbol of nationalism.